

1975

JANUARY 6

Phuoc Long falls to communist troops.

JANUARY 21

President Ford rules out renewed American military intervention in Vietnam.

MARCH 10–11

The seizure of Ban Ma Thuot in the Central Highlands opens the final communist offensive in South Vietnam.

MARCH 13

President Thieu decides to withdraw his forces to a defensive perimeter around Saigon and the Mekong Delta.

MARCH 30

Da Nang quickly falls to communist forces as South Vietnamese military and civilian morale collapses.

APRIL 9–20

At Xuan Loc, outnumbered South Vietnamese troops put up valiant resistance but are eventually forced to fall back on Saigon.

APRIL 17

In Cambodia, Khmer Rouge guerrillas occupy the capital Phnom Penh and forcibly evacuate the population to the countryside.



Khmer Rouge guerrilla in Phnom Penh, April 1975

APRIL 21

President Thieu resigns, denouncing the Americans for abandoning South Vietnam to its fate.